

Animal Health and Livestock Services Professionals Council Act, 2022

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Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner Council Act, 2079

Certification and Publication Date

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Act Number 29 of the year 2079 made by the Federal Parliament

An Act Made to Provide for the Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner Council

Preamble: Whereas, it is expedient to establish an Animal Health and Animal Service Council to organize, standardize, and mobilize the services and professions of Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioners, other than veterinarians whose names are registered or are eligible to be registered with the Nepal Veterinary Council established under the prevailing law, in a structured, quality-oriented, and dignified manner, and to develop an effective animal health and animal service profession,

The Federal Parliament has enacted this Act. Chapter-1

Preliminary

1. Short Title and Commencement: (1) This Act may be cited as the "Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner Council Act, 2079".

(2) This Act shall come into force on the thirty-first day from the date of its certification. 2. Definition: Unless the subject or context otherwise requires, in this Act,-

(a) "Chairperson" means the Chairperson of the Council.

(b) "Vice-chairperson" means the Vice-chairperson of the Council.

(c) "Prescribed" or "as prescribed" means prescribed or as prescribed in this Act or the rules or regulations made under this Act.

(d) "Register" means the book prepared for registering the names of Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioners under this Act.

(e) "Animal" means any kind of domestic or wild animal, bird, or fish, and the word also denotes other aquatic animals and amphibians.

(f) "Animal Health and Animal Service Profession" means the treatment, diagnosis, prevention of diseases of sick animals, or any work related to the animal health and animal service profession.

(g) "Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner" means an Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner registered under this Act.

(h) "Council" means the Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner Council constituted pursuant to Section 5.

(i) "Ministry" means the Ministry of the Government of Nepal dealing with matters relating to animal development.

(j) "Registrar" means the person appointed or designated pursuant to Section 25.

(k) "Member" means a member of the Council, and the word also denotes the Chairperson and Vice-chairperson. Chapter-2

Establishment, Constitution, Functions, Duties and Powers of the Council

3.

Establishment of the Council: (1) An Animal Health and Animal Service Council shall be established to make arrangements, including registering names according to qualifications under the provincial law, to organize, make quality-oriented and dignified the services and professions of Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioners, other than veterinarians whose names are registered or are eligible to be registered with the Nepal Veterinary Council under the prevailing law. (2) The office of the Council shall be located in the Kathmandu Valley. 4. Council to be an Autonomous and Corporate Body: (1) The Council shall be an autonomous corporate body with perpetual succession and shall acquire a legal personality. (2) As a legal entity, the Council shall exercise rights, perform duties, and discharge liabilities in accordance with the prevailing law. 5. Constitution of the Council: (1) The Council shall consist of the following members:- (a) One person nominated by the Government of Nepal from among Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioners registered at least in "Class B" and having five years of experience as an Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner - Chairperson (b) One person elected from among Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioners registered at least in "Class B" - Vice-chairperson (c) Two persons nominated by the Ministry from among Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioners, including at least one woman - Member (d) Seven persons, one each elected from each province from among Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioners - Member (e) Four persons elected from among Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioners, including at least two women - Member (f) Two persons nominated by the Council from among universities or institutes teaching subjects related to the Animal Health and Animal Service Profession and from the Council for Technical Education and Vocational Training, including at least one woman - Member (g) One office bearer representative of the Nepal Veterinary Council - Member (h) Registrar - Member-Secretary (2) The election of members under clauses (b), (d), and (e) of sub-section (1) shall be as prescribed. (3) The term of office of nominated and elected members under sub-section (1) shall be four years. After the expiry of their term, they may be nominated or elected for one more term. (4) Notwithstanding anything contained in sub-section (3), if any member acts in a manner contrary to the functions, duties, and powers of the Council, the Government of Nepal may remove such member from office at any time.

Provided that, before removal, such person shall be given an opportunity to submit a defense.

(5) If the office of any member falls vacant before the expiry of the term under sub-section (3), the Council may nominate or elect another member for the remaining period. Provided that nomination or election shall not be made for a vacancy of less than one year.

(6) Until the Council under sub-section (1) is constituted, the Government of Nepal may constitute a committee ensuring representation from the sectors mentioned in sub-section (1) to carry out the functions to

be performed by the Council.

(7) While constituting a committee under sub-section (6), it shall be constituted from among persons who have acquired the necessary qualifications for the concerned Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner pursuant to Section 17.

(8) The term of the committee constituted under sub-section (6) shall be a maximum of one year.

(9) While nominating or electing members under sub-section (1), it shall be done on the basis of the principle of inclusiveness.

(10) While electing or nominating members to the Council under sub-section (1), it shall be done on a rotational basis to ensure representation from all sectors related to animal service and animal health. 6. Disqualification: A person shall be disqualified for nomination or election as a member of the Council in the following circumstances:-

(a) If a non-Nepali citizen,

(b) If the name has been removed from the Register,

(c) If convicted by a court for corruption, rape, human trafficking and transportation, sale, distribution, or trafficking of narcotic drugs, money laundering, passport misuse, kidnapping, or other criminal offenses involving moral turpitude,

(d) If blacklisted under the prevailing law,

(e) If unable to serve on the Council due to physical or mental illness,

(f) If adjudged insolvent under the prevailing law. 7. Circumstances for Termination of Membership: (1) Membership of the Council shall be deemed terminated in the following circumstances:-

(a) If disqualified to remain a member pursuant to Section 6,

(b) If a member resigns from office,

(c) If absent from more than three consecutive meetings of the Council without notifying the Council with reasons,

(d) Upon death.

(2) While resigning under clause (b) of sub-section (1), the Chairperson shall submit the resignation to the Government of Nepal through the Ministry, and other members shall submit it to the Chairperson. 8.

Functions, Duties and Powers of the Council: The functions, duties and powers of the Council shall be as follows:- (a) To formulate necessary policies, plans, and programs to make the Animal Health and Animal Service profession well-organized, standard, dignified, and effective, and submit them to the Ministry for approval, (b) To implement, or cause to be implemented, policies, plans, and programs approved by the Government of Nepal for the smooth operation of the Animal Health and Animal Service profession, (c) To prepare national standards for Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioners and implement them after approval from the Ministry, (d) To advise the Ministry on making animal and animal product production, animal breeding material production, processing, distribution, and animal husbandry systems quality-oriented, (e) To determine the qualifications of Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioners, (f) To coordinate with provincial governments and local levels concerning the Animal Health and Animal Service profession, (g) To

collect and update integrated records related to the Animal Health and Animal Service profession from the body designated by the provincial law, (h) To prepare and implement, or cause to be implemented, a national-level code of conduct for Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioners, (i) To provide necessary advice to the Ministry on matters related to animal health and animal service, (j) To submit suggestions to the Ministry for implementing matters suitable for Nepal by exchanging research or experiences related to animal health service in accordance with international practices, (k) To inspect, supervise, and monitor compliance with the code of conduct determined by the Council, and if non-compliance is found, remove the name of such Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner from the register of the Council if registered with the Council, or write to the provincial body to remove the name from its register if registered with a provincial body, (l) To perform other functions necessary for achieving the objectives of the Council. 9.

Meeting of the Council: (1) Meetings of the Council shall be held on such date, time, and place as specified by the Chairperson. (2) Meetings of the Council shall ordinarily be held four times a year. (3) The meeting of the Council shall be chaired by the Chairperson, and in their absence, by the Vice-chairperson, and if both are absent, by the senior-most member among the members present. (4) The presence of more than fifty percent of the total number of members of the Council shall constitute a quorum for a meeting of the Council. (5) The decision of the majority in a meeting of the Council shall be binding, and in case of a tie, the person chairing the meeting shall have a casting vote. (6) Decisions of the Council shall be certified by the Chairperson and the Registrar. (7) The allowance and other facilities for members participating in meetings shall be as prescribed. (8) Other procedures relating to meetings of the Council shall be as determined by the Council itself. 10. Functions, Duties and Powers of the Chairperson: In addition to the functions, duties and powers mentioned elsewhere in this Act, the functions, duties and powers of the Chairperson shall be as follows:- (a) To determine the priority of subjects to be discussed in the meeting of the Council. (b) To monitor and evaluate the programs operated by the Council, or cause them to be monitored and evaluated, and give necessary directions in this regard. (c) To manage, or cause to be managed, the functioning of the Council in an organized, effective, and smooth manner. (d) To perform other functions necessary for achieving the objectives of the Council. 11. Vice-chairperson to Act: In the absence of the Chairperson, the functions performed by the Chairperson shall be performed by the Vice-chairperson. Chapter-3 Provisions Relating to Registration of Names 12. Not to Practice Animal Health and Animal Service Profession without Registration: (1) No person shall practice the Animal Health and Animal Service profession without registering their name under this Act. Provided that veterinarians whose names are registered with the Nepal Veterinary Council under the prevailing law shall not be required to register their names under this Act. (2) Notwithstanding anything contained in sub-section (1), a person applying for registration pursuant to sub-section (2) of Section 13 shall not be prevented from practicing the Animal Health and Animal Service profession until a final decision is made regarding such application. 13.

Application for Registration: (1) An Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner who has fulfilled the qualifications as mentioned in the Schedule from a recognized university, teaching institution, educational council, or educational foundation shall submit an application as prescribed to register their name in the Register. (2) An Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner who has fulfilled the qualifications as mentioned in the Schedule and is engaged in the Animal Health and Animal Service profession at the time of commencement of this Act shall submit an application pursuant to sub-section (1) to register their name in the Register within one year from the date of commencement of this Act. (3) An Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner applying for registration under sub-section (1) or (2) shall attach the prescribed documents and fee relating to their qualification with the application. (4) Notwithstanding anything contained in sub-section (1) or (3), if the provincial law has separate provisions regarding the procedure for submitting

applications, documents to be submitted with the application, and fees, it shall be according to that law. 14. Action on Application: (1) The body designated by the provincial law shall, upon receiving an application pursuant to Section 12, examine whether the certificate and degree submitted regarding qualification are recognized and whether the application is in proper form, and decide whether or not to register the applicant's name in the Register within the period specified by the provincial law. (2) If the concerned body of the provincial government decides to register the applicant's name under sub-section (1), it shall register the applicant's name in the Register and issue a certificate of registration in the prescribed format. (3) If it decides not to register the applicant's name under sub-section (1), the body designated by the provincial law shall notify the applicant of such decision. 15. Removal of Name and Re-registration: (1) The body designated by the provincial law may order the removal of the name of any Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner from the Register in any of the following circumstances:- (a) If punished by a court for corruption, rape, human trafficking and transportation, sale, distribution, or trafficking of narcotic drugs, money laundering, passport misuse, kidnapping, or other criminal offenses involving moral turpitude, (b) If determined by a two-thirds majority of the Council that the prescribed professional conduct has not been followed, (c) If blacklisted under the prevailing law, (d) If unable to work as an Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner due to physical or mental illness. (2) An Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner whose name has been removed from the Register under sub-section (1) may apply for re-registration stating reasonable grounds.

If the grounds appear reasonable, the body designated by the provincial law shall re-register the name of such Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner in the Register and issue a certificate. 16. Cancellation of Certificate: If information is received that the name of a person not qualified under this Act has been erroneously registered in the Register, and upon inquiry, it is found to be true, the body designated by the provincial law may cancel the registration by withdrawing the certificate of registration of such person. 17. Categories of Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioners: For the purpose of registering the names of Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioners under this Act, Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioners who have fulfilled the qualifications mentioned below shall have their names registered in the following categories:-

(a) "Class A": An Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner who has completed a post-graduate degree or Doctor of Philosophy in the relevant subject from a recognized university or teaching institution.

(b) "Class B": An Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner who has obtained at least a Bachelor's degree or equivalent degree in a subject related to the Animal Health and Animal Service profession from a recognized university or teaching institution, or who has obtained at least ten years of experience in "Class C" and has fulfilled the continuous education criteria as prescribed by the Council.

(c) "Class C": An Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner who has obtained at least a Proficiency Certificate level or equivalent degree in a subject related to the Animal Health and Animal Service profession from a recognized teaching institution, or who has obtained at least five years of experience in "Class D" and has fulfilled the continuous education criteria as prescribed by the Council.

(d) "Class D": An Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner who has obtained at least a Technical S.L.C. or equivalent degree in a subject related to the Animal Health and Animal Service profession from a recognized teaching institution. 18. Entitlement to Practice Animal Health and Animal Service Profession: An Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner shall be entitled to perform specified functions related to the Animal Health and Animal Service profession based on their educational qualification and training as

prescribed, among the animal health and animal service professions pursuant to Section 17. 19.

May Conduct Examination: (1) In order to maintain the necessary quality in the Animal Health and Animal Service profession, the body responsible for registration may conduct an examination as prescribed for Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioners wishing to register their names under this Act before registration. (2) If provision is made for conducting an examination under sub-section (1), a person who fails such examination shall not have their name registered in the Register. 20. Rural Animal Health Worker: (1) For Rural Animal Health Workers who have received training for a prescribed period from the Government of Nepal before the commencement of this Act and have been carrying out the Animal Health and Animal Service profession, the body designated by the provincial law may make arrangements to keep a separate register and register their names until the qualifications mentioned in the Schedule are fulfilled. (2) Rural Animal Health Workers registered under sub-section (1) may carry out the Animal Health and Animal Service profession as prescribed. (3) The body designated by the provincial law may regulate whether the prescribed functions are being performed by Rural Animal Health Workers registered under sub-section (1). (4) If a Rural Animal Health Worker registered under this Section has obtained a certificate to that effect and has continuously carried out the Animal Health and Animal Service profession for ten years, such practitioner may, after a skill test and upon success, be registered in the category under clause (d) of Section 17. (5) Other arrangements relating to the registration, regulation, and capacity building of Rural Animal Health Workers shall be as prescribed. 21. Council to Perform: (1) Notwithstanding anything contained elsewhere in this Chapter, until a provincial law is made, the functions to be performed by the body designated by the provincial law shall be performed by the Council. (2) While performing functions under sub-section (1), the Council shall adhere to the prescribed period and fee under this Chapter. Chapter-4 Recognition of Educational Degrees and Certificates 22. Recognition of Educational Qualification: (1) Upon the recommendation of the Council, the Ministry may grant recognition to certificates of educational qualification or other degrees related to the Animal Health and Animal Service profession. (2) The subject matter for which recognition is granted under sub-section (1) and the name of the teaching institution providing such certificate of educational qualification or other degree shall be published in the Nepal Gazette. (3) Other arrangements relating to granting recognition to educational qualifications shall be as prescribed. 23.

May Prescribe Standards: (1) The Council may prescribe conditions and standards to be fulfilled by teaching institutions related to the Animal Health and Animal Service profession while conducting educational programs. (2) Teaching institutions related to the Animal Health and Animal Service profession that are in operation at the time of commencement of this Act shall fulfill such conditions and standards within six months of the prescription under sub-section (1). (3) Notwithstanding anything contained elsewhere in this Chapter, the policy and standards regarding the curriculum, admission conditions, and examination system of teaching institutions providing educational qualifications eligible for registration with the Nepal Veterinary Council under the prevailing law, and the subjects related to degrees and certificates provided by such institutions, shall be according to that law. (4) If the standards are not fulfilled within the prescribed time under sub-section (2) or if a breach of standards is found, the Council may recommend to the concerned body for the cancellation of the approval of such teaching institution. 24. May Conduct Evaluation: (1) The Council may evaluate the curriculum and admission conditions determined by the teaching institution providing the certificate of educational qualification or other degree recognized under Section 22 for such certificate or other degree. (2) For the purpose of sub-section (1), the Council may request documents and details from such teaching institution as needed. (3) It shall be the duty of the concerned institution to provide the documents and details as requested by the Council under sub-section (2). 25. May Cancel Recognition: (1) If, based on the documents and details obtained under Section 24, the Council finds that the curriculum,

admission conditions, study and teaching methods, and examination procedures determined by the concerned teaching institution for the certificate or degree for which recognition was granted by the Council are not appropriate or adequate, the Council shall submit a report with its opinion and suggestions to the Ministry. (2) After receiving the Council's report under sub-section (1), the Ministry may, if deemed necessary, request further details or clarification from the concerned teaching institution.

It shall be the duty of the concerned teaching institution to provide such further details or clarification as requested by the Council within the prescribed time.

(3) If, upon studying the report received from the Council under sub-section (1) or the details or clarification received under sub-section (2), the Ministry finds it necessary to conduct further inquiry, it may cause further inquiry to be conducted through a committee or task force comprising experts.

(4) Based on the report under sub-section (1), the clarification received under sub-section (2), and the inquiry report, the Ministry may cancel the recognition granted under Section 22 for the certificate of educational qualification or other degree related to the Animal Health and Animal Service profession issued by such teaching institution after a certain date. Notice of such cancellation of recognition shall be published in the Nepal Gazette. 26. Supervision of Examination: (1) The Council may supervise examinations conducted by the concerned teaching institution for the certificate of educational qualification or other degree recognized under Section 22.

(2) For the supervision of examinations under sub-section (1), the Council may appoint and send supervisors as needed.

(3) A supervisor appointed under sub-section (2) shall submit a report to the Council containing the prescribed details regarding the examinations they supervised.

(4) A supervisor appointed under sub-section (2) shall not interfere in the examination in any manner.

Chapter-5

Provisions Relating to Employees

27. Registrar: (1) The Ministry may appoint the Registrar of the Council by open competition as prescribed, selecting an Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner who has obtained a Bachelor's degree from a recognized university and is registered at least in "Class B" to act as the administrative chief of the Council.

(2) The service, terms, and facilities of the Registrar shall be as prescribed.

(3) In the absence of the Registrar, or until a Registrar is appointed under sub-section (1), the Ministry may designate a government employee of Nepal or any employee of the Council who meets the qualifications for Registrar to act as Registrar. 28. Functions, Duties and Powers of the Registrar: In addition to the functions, duties and powers mentioned elsewhere in this Act, the functions, duties and powers of the Registrar shall be as follows:-

(a) To prepare the agenda for discussion to be presented in the meeting of the Council in consultation with the Chairperson.

(b) To implement, or cause to be implemented, the decisions of the Council.

(c) To perform other functions as prescribed. 29.

Employees of the Council: (1) The organizational structure of the Council shall be as approved by the

Ministry, based on the workload, resources, and financial capacity of the Council. (2) Prior to approving the organizational structure under sub-section (1), the consent of the Ministry of Finance, Government of Nepal, shall be obtained. (3) The Council may appoint employees as prescribed for the posts established according to the organizational structure approved under sub-section (1). (4) Employees appointed under sub-section (3) shall be under the direct supervision and control of the Registrar.

Chapter-6 Fund of the Council

30. Fund of the Council: (1) There shall be a separate Fund of the Council. (2) The Fund under sub-section (1) shall consist of the following amounts:- (a) Amounts received from the Government of Nepal, provincial government, or local level, (b) Amounts received as assistance from domestic associations and institutions, (c) Amounts received as assistance from foreign governments or international associations and institutions, (d) Other amounts earned by the Council. (3) Prior to receiving amounts under clause (c) of sub-section (2), approval from the Ministry of Finance, Government of Nepal, shall be required. (4) The amount of the Fund under sub-section (1) shall be deposited by opening an account in any commercial bank designated by the Council in the name of the Council. (5) All expenses incurred in the name of the Council shall be borne by the Fund under sub-section (1). (6) The operation of the Fund under sub-section (1) shall be as prescribed.

31. Accounts and Audit: (1) The accounts of income and expenditure of the Council shall be kept in the format adopted by the Government of Nepal. (2) The internal audit of the income and expenditure of the Council shall be conducted by an auditor designated by the Council from among registered auditors, and the final audit shall be conducted by an auditor designated by the Auditor General. (3) The Government of Nepal may, if it so desires, inspect or cause to be inspected the account-related documents of the Fund of the Council at any time.

Chapter-7 Offenses and Penalties

32. Deemed to have Committed an Offense: Practicing the Animal Health and Animal Service profession without registration of name pursuant to Section 12 shall be deemed to have committed an offense under this Act.

33.

Penalty: (1) A person committing an offense pursuant to Section 32 shall be liable to a fine of up to fifty thousand rupees or imprisonment for up to six months or both, depending on the gravity of the offense. (2) Except as mentioned in sub-section (1), if any person does any work contrary to this Act or the rules made under this Act, such person shall be liable to a fine of up to thirty thousand rupees.

Chapter-8 Miscellaneous

34. Investigation and Diary of Cases: The investigation of cases punishable under Section 33 shall be conducted by an officer of the Council designated by the Council, and after the completion of such investigation, the case shall be filed in the concerned District Court after obtaining the opinion of the government attorney.

35. Government of Nepal to be Plaintiff: The Government of Nepal shall be the plaintiff in cases under this Act.

36. Dissolution of the Council: (1) If the Council fails to exercise the powers conferred upon it according to this Act or the rules made under this Act, misuses its powers, exercises powers beyond those conferred, or fails to perform the duties required to be performed by the Council under this Act and the rules made under this Act, the Government of Nepal may dissolve the Council. Provided that, before dissolving the Council, the Council shall be given an opportunity to improve or rectify its functions and proceedings. (2) After the Council is dissolved under sub-section (1), the Government of Nepal may retain the Fund and other properties of the Council under its own responsibility and may itself perform all the functions required to be performed by the Council under this Act and the rules made under this Act, or may constitute a committee and cause them to be performed by such committee, until another Council is constituted. (3) Within six months of the dissolution of the Council under sub-section (1), the Government of Nepal shall constitute another Council pursuant to sub-section (1) of Section 5. (4) After another Council is constituted under sub-section (3), the Government of Nepal shall transfer the Fund and properties retained under its responsibility pursuant to sub-section (2) to that Council.

37. Committee: (1) The Council may constitute various thematic committees as prescribed to implement the decisions of the Council. (2) The functions,

duties, and powers of the thematic committees constituted under sub-section (1) shall be as prescribed. 38.

Delegation of Powers: The Council may, as necessary, delegate some of the powers conferred upon it under this Act to the Chairperson, Vice-chairperson, or Members. 39. Subject to this Act: Matters described in this Act shall be according to this Act, and other matters shall be according to the prevailing law. 40. Contact with Government of Nepal: When contacting the Government of Nepal, the Council shall do so through the Ministry. 41. Act Implementation Review: Within one year of the completion of five years from the commencement of this Act, and thereafter within one year after every five years, the Ministry shall review the implementation of the Act and shall submit a report thereof to the relevant committee of both houses of the Federal Parliament. 42. Power to Make Rules: The Government of Nepal may make necessary rules for the implementation of this Act. 43. Power to Make Regulations: (1) The Council may make necessary regulations on matters relating to employee recruitment, service terms and facilities, and the functioning of the Council. (2) Regulations made under sub-section (1) shall come into force after approval by the Ministry. (3) Prior to granting approval under sub-section (2), the Ministry shall obtain the consent of the Ministry of Finance on matters involving financial liability. 44. May Make Directives and Procedures: Subject to this Act and the rules made under this Act, the Council may, with the approval of the Ministry, make necessary directives and procedures. 45. Amendment to Schedule: The Government of Nepal may, by publishing a notice in the Nepal Gazette, amend the Schedule as necessary. Schedule (Related to Section 13) Qualifications of Animal Health and Animal Service Practitioner (a) Having passed S.E.E. or equivalent and obtained one year of Stock Supervisor training, (b) Having passed Technical S.E.E. or equivalent in Animal Health and Animal Husbandry, (c) Having passed S.E.E. or equivalent and completed the J.T.A. Course (Animal Science), (d) Having passed S.E.E. or equivalent and passed the skill test in Animal Science at Level-2 from the Council for Technical Education and Vocational Training, (e) Having passed a Certificate level in Animal Science or completed grade twelve in a subject related to Animal Health and Animal Service, or completed a Technical Certificate level, Diploma (3 years) course, or (f) Having passed a Bachelor's degree or equivalent in Animal Science or Fisheries Science, or completed a Master's degree or Doctor of Philosophy in a related subject.